

Note: Times were missing, added time range information where possible.

Interviewer: [00:00:01] Yes, we're recording. Do you have a problem with me taking notes?

Speaker: [00:00:06] Nah, it doesn't make any difference to me if you record audio.

Interviewer: [00:00:09] Okay, thank you very much for agreeing to be interviewed.

Speaker: [00:00:12] But you're not going to take video, just audio, right?

Interviewer: [00:00:13] No, just the audio. I mean, he's recording the video and the audio right now, but they'll be hidden from me, and we won't share your audio, actually.

Speaker: [00:00:27] Got it okay

Interviewer: [00:00:27] I will take and share as much as you allow.

Speaker: [00:00:29] There is no problem with my voice. No problem at all.

Interviewer: [00:00:31] Excellent, can you confirm that you have read the consent form and that you are participating in the study, that you are participating voluntarily?

Speaker: [00:00:40] Yes, I confirm.

Interviewer: [00:00:42] Okay, thank you very much. How old are you? I have a couple of questions about, uh, your relationships.

Speaker: [00:00:47] [46-50]. So [46-50], rounded up, yes. [46-50].

Interviewer: [00:00:54] How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: [00:00:58] Mmmm [11-15] years in total uh. We've been married for [1-5] years.

Interviewer: [00:01:06] Okay, do you have children?

Speaker: [00:01:09] We have no children together. But my spouse has two daughters from her previous marriage.

Interviewer: [00:01:16] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker: [00:01:20] My spouse, me, one cat [11-15] years old. And our dog is [1-5] years old (Laughs). We are a very crowded family (Laughs).

Interviewer: [00:01:30] Exactly. Do you mind if I ask about your main source of income?

Speaker: [00:01:36] No, no. I uh, in total I get [Income] at work. I have been an [Job Title] for [26-30] years. I don't know exactly my husband's income but he also

Interviewer: [00:01:50] The income itself is not important.

Speaker: [00:01:50] [Job Title].

Interviewer: [00:01:51] O da [Job Title]

Speaker: [00:01:52] Sir?

Interviewer: [00:01:53] It doesn't matter how much the income is.

Speaker: [00:01:55] [Job Title]

Interviewer: [00:01:55] [Job Title]

Speaker: [00:01:56] I got it.

Interviewer: [00:01:58] I continue to refer to your spouse. Your spouse.

Speaker: [00:02:02] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:02:02] If you prefer another word, that's fine too.

Speaker: [00:02:04] No, no. It's just that your voice sounds very distant to me, whereas the last time I turned up the volume.

Interviewer: [00:02:10] One second, experience it like this. How are we? Are we the same? Interviewer.

Speaker: [00:02:15] It's better now.

Interviewer: [00:02:16] It's better now.

Speaker: [00:02:16] Cool. Very good. [00:02:00] Speaker.

Interviewer: [00:02:19] Uh, would you like to tell me the story of how you met? How you met your spouse?

Speaker: [00:02:24] It's actually a very interesting way of meeting. I was [Previous Job Title]. I'm an [Job Title], I'm an [Job Title], I also [Hobby]. At that time, an [Colleague] recommended me to my spouse's daughter to give lessons and that's how they found me. But of course we weren't lovers at that time. After a while the girls loved me very much. Actually, there was someone else in my husband's life. There was someone else in my life, but just like in the movies, I don't know what happened and what ended. We started to enjoy each other. My relationship was going badly and it was over. And of course, his eldest daughter was very much attached to me with a great love and interest. She also played a big role. I was very impressed by the fact that he was such a good father and so on. But I was very impressed by his beautiful heart, his relationship with children, his view of the world. We went to the theater together with the kids, we went camping together, we spent so much time together, and in the meantime we realized that we were actually having something super nice, and we have been together since that day and I'm glad we are together. You know, we became a good couple as two very different characters (laughs).

Interviewer: [00:04:16] How would you rate the quality of the relationship you're in compared to the relationship with friends, acquaintances?

Speaker: [00:04:27] Of course, I don't evaluate outside, but uh, I mean, when I look at it like this and we women talk about our relationships with each other like this, we gossip like this. But I think I have a different relationship. My husband is more respectful, we are still in the [11-15] year after [11-15] years. Even the way we address each other hasn't changed much. I haven't addressed him by his name yet, because I don't like such words like my love, my baby and so on. I call her "my half" and she calls me "my rose". That's how it goes. And when you look at it, I

can't compare it with other relationships, because ours is neither like a married couple's relationship. I think we are a couple who spend time with each other quite pleasantly when they spend time with each other and do it well when they want to get away from each other. And I see it as the main thing that our relationship is going well. We protect each other's boundaries well. I don't know if I gave you a complete answer.

Interviewer: [00:06:05] So do I understand you correctly, you said that even though you find it difficult to compare your relationship because of its differences, because of its uniqueness, even though you don't know how to compare it, these differences make it better.

Speaker: [00:06:24] I mean, actually, I can't make such an accurate comparison because the comparison will vary according to the structures of the people. Right. But I think it is a very good and high quality relationship compared to many relationships.

Interviewer: [00:06:43] We don't expect you to be objective, we are interested in how it looks from your own point of view.

Speaker: [00:06:53] I think a good relationship, a good relationship is someone of my nature, if it wasn't a good relationship, it would have been long gone. Because I was not a person who looked at marriage at all, and when my spouse proposed to me after [6-10] years, I mean, I said yes to marriage with the support of a psychologist, because my biggest fear is to get married. Because I lived alone for [16-20] years, you know, this question really made me think that yes, I think it is a good relationship.

Interviewer: [00:07:29] Can we ask how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker: [00:07:34] I mean, I swear it's been quite a lot (laughs). But seriously, really [1-5]. One of them lasted for [1-5] years and one lasted for [1-5] years. One of them lasted about a year and a half, but I mean, the only relationship that flowed with such quality and joy was my relationship with my spouse.

Interviewer: [00:08:02] You answered the next question before I asked it. I was going to ask you how you see your current relationship compared to them.

Speaker: [00:08:10] Huh, I mean, this one is a much more mutually nurturing relationship, which was not the case in the others. Well, usually it was always a relationship about stroking my ego, about making me happy in the past, maybe what I liked here is that it felt more realistic to me. I mean, there is no show, to be honest.

Interviewer: [00:08:10] Why was it important for you not to have a show?

Speaker: [00:08:40] Uh, in my previous relationship, [1-5] years before my husband, I was very worn out. I had a very big betrayal when it lasted for about [1-5] years because uh, it was like this constant cargo of gifts, dictionaries of love, the ultimate in pampering. And I started to feel very uncomfortable after that relationship. It bothered me that things were so soggy and overdone. But I never experienced that with my husband. Everything seemed so normal and healthy. He was doing it because he felt it. So I didn't feel that he was bluffing or trying to pull the wool over my eyes. As a matter of fact, it's been the same for years. It's the same now as it was then.

Interviewer: [00:09:33] What makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker: [00:09:38] People's respect for each other, I think it's good that they know their stopping points, you know, where to stop, and without losing respect, they can do something in common and walk this path together.

Interviewer: [00:10:04] Would you like to expand a little bit more on respect and partnership?

Speaker: [00:10:09] For example, watching a movie, going to the theater, going to a concert, eating out, spicing up our special days with mutual surprises, even if they are small. It's something that happens in our relationship, to be able to continue that flirtation and courtship happening in a new relationship.

Interviewer: [00:10:44] Do you want to expand a little bit more on knowing the boundaries?

Speaker: [00:10:47] Sir?

Interviewer: [00:10:49] Do you want to expand a little bit more on knowing the boundaries?

Speaker: [00:10:52] Um, it's like this, not controlling each other's lives. I mean, what is it? Not involving your family too much and not interfering too much, for example, in each other's lives. When my husband wants to be with his friends, I never question why he is with them. Or when I'm going somewhere, it's not something like asking for permission, you know, not can I go, I'm thinking of going, you know, do you have a program at that time, is it convenient for you? When you say that there, the other party may perceive it differently and cause something else, but instead of asking if I can go, I'm planning to go to Istanbul on this date, do you want to come with me? Or is there anything we can do together on that date or not? I ask that. We make a plan and program accordingly. That's what I mean by borders or things like that.

Interviewer: [00:12:15] What makes a relationship low quality then?

Speaker: [00:12:19] What I think makes it low quality, I'll tell you what I experienced in my previous relationship. For me, things like not listening to you, not empathizing, kind of ignoring you, actually.

Interviewer: [00:13:04] What is love for you?

Speaker: [00:13:08] What is love for me? I mean, if you had asked me [11-15] years ago, I would have answered differently, but now love (aşk) is labor, love (sevgi), respect for each other. But especially in the last [1-5] years after [46-50], I realized that a relationship is something far beyond someone's eyebrows, eyes, type, height, pose or I don't know, smile. The relationship is the way he looks at you, the words he says to you, the little gestures and beautiful things he makes to you. Or, um, when we leave the house, we always say goodbye to each other, we kiss each other. I go very early in the morning, around 7:30. If he wakes up, we leave in a very nice way. I come early in the evening, when he comes late, I greet him at the door and kiss him. I think love (aşk), labor, walking in a mutual relationship with each other is what I think for me right now.

Interviewer:[00:14:39] Walking together.

Interviewer:[00:14:43] What was it before?

Speaker: [00:14:43] labor.

Speaker: [00:14:44] Before, love for me was someone making me happy, spoiling me, making my heart flutter, or waiting for something that made me feel that someone was thinking about me. Now, when I don't get flowers on a special day, I don't wonder why he didn't buy me flowers. Or I don't even think about why he didn't buy me flowers. Because I know that the subject has been replaced by something else. I transformed to a nice kiss, a hug, a sweet touch, something else.

Interviewer: [00:15:52] Showless, sincere.

Speaker: [00:15:55] Sir?

Interviewer: [00:15:56] It's show-free and intimate.

Interviewer: [00:15:59] Showless

Speaker: [00:15:59] Echo.

Speaker: [00:16:02] Super, that's exactly what it is, so what comes from the inside is something realistic and something that makes you happier, a feeling.

Interviewer: [00:16:13] So what are the most important things in a relationship for you? We talked about one part in one context but in another context. The most important things in a relationship.

Speaker: [00:16:25] Well, in fact, the totality of what I mentioned before, respect, labor, love (sevgi), the value you give to each other, being able to empathize, when necessary, when he is angry, how can I say something different in that situation, you know, not to go over his own will, but to manage him, maybe to get away, maybe to take a step that will make him happy. A relationship, especially a relationship between a man and a woman, is something that requires serious intelligence. It's not just something that happens with your wishes. I think you should do something by thinking about the other person and trying to feel what his feelings are at that moment.

Interviewer:[00:17:30] It sounds like you described the ability of individuals to put their own needs aside when necessary and respond to the needs of the other party.

Speaker: [00:17:38] Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah.

Interviewer:[00:17:47] What went through your mind? You seemed to have evaluated something.

Speaker: [00:17:50] Now I've looked at how I'm answering these questions and I'm doing something like this. I'm thinking. Right now I always give all my answers through my experiences, you know, not classical writings and so on. That's why I try to answer by thinking and mixing the past with the present.

Interviewer: [00:18:15] That's exactly what we want. Your ideas and thoughts that come out of your experiences. So thank you for that.

Speaker: [00:18:21] You know, in such book-like terms, love is this, relationship is this, relationship should be this and that. I am an individual who can really convey this very well in this sense. I am experiencing this relationship by experiencing negative relationships before, and if I had married or continued with my first two relationships, I would definitely have ended

this relationship. Or if [Partner] was my first relationship, I would have ended it again. I am someone who has experienced that experience is very, very important, how important it is for a person to walk with someone after a certain maturity.

Interviewer: [00:19:06] So how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: [00:19:12] So how important is love in a relationship? As I mentioned before, love meant something very different to me [11-15] years ago. For me, what I experience now is something far beyond love. If you want to explain what's beyond, we are a couple who respect each other, who try to understand each other, who still make little flirtations with each other, if the name of this is love, yes there is love. But if you say, do you have butterflies in your heart, do you still think of him romantically and miss him far away? Of course, there is no such thing right now because I am with him and I live with him all the time. But I can say this. When I go away, when this separation lasts longer than 5 days, yes, I miss him, I miss his smell, I miss his skin, I still desire him in a sexual sense, if that's what love is, yes, for example, I heard from my friends around me who are married or have a lover. They don't like his smell, they can't tolerate it anymore, it's repulsive, they don't like the way he drinks tea, they don't like the way he eats. When I hear these sentences, I say yes, then if I don't feel uncomfortable with anything about this man and if this is love, then yes, I'm still in love. (Laughs)

Interviewer: [00:21:03] If I understand you correctly, you said that the way you define it is very important but the standard definitions are not very important when you try to define it with more ephemeral things like excitement, passion.

Speaker: [00:21:18] Yes, yes, yes, yes.

Interviewer: [00:21:20] Because your definitions already included labor, respect and togetherness, and since we're talking about sexuality, do you mind if I ask you a few questions?

Speaker: [00:21:36] No.

Interviewer: [00:21:40] How satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: [00:21:44] I am quite satisfied. I mean, when we think about the average in [Country A], we are a couple who have sex quite often, I mean, not once a month or something like that. Or when I compare it with my other relationships, I mean, when I think about the enjoyment thing, I enjoy [Partner] a lot. I am in a menopause right now. Because when I hear from my friends that in menopause they use sexuality as a trump card against their spouses, but I don't have such a thing, [Partner] is a very respectful person in sexuality. He is not like any [Ethnicity] man who has ever been in my life. Feelings of the woman in front of him, her satisfaction, her mood at that moment is very precious primarily.

Speaker: [00:22:54] Well, I am a woman who enjoys him very much every time I am with him or when I cuddle and sleep with him, I am a woman who says, "I am glad I am with him." (Laughs) Because [Ethnicity] women are very prejudiced against sexuality. They have a lot of taboos. [REDACTED]. We don't have taboos in that sense. We are a couple who talk to each other and find out what each other enjoys. Of course, that's my opinion, but I think he is like that too. I mean, since we enjoy living together, if I felt something different, I would feel uncomfortable too.

Interviewer: [00:23:57] If I understand correctly, you have a free sexuality, you enjoy it

Speaker: [00:24:04] Yes

Interviewer: [00:24:04] and that you are both respectful and sensitive to each other's preferences and needs.

Speaker: [00:24:11] Absolutely yes. You put it very well.

Interviewer: [00:24:16] Can I ask you how often you have sexual intercourse these days, if you could give me a number, a week a month?

Speaker: [00:24:24] I mean, I can say that we have sex two or three times a week, or at least twice, but there are such periods. I get up very early. Or as I said, because of this process I'm going through, sometimes I'm hormonally very distressed, which he is very understanding of. I mean, if we haven't been together for the longest time, let's say once every two weeks, or let's say twice in two weeks, but I mean, it doesn't seem to me that it's been too long. I do spoiled things. I mean, because I kiss her all the time, so it's not like let's make love. Yes, I'm ready or something like that. For example, he lights a candle, he says, "Oh, he says it's very sexy." You know, something always drives us, triggers us. We don't have anything like let's make love as if it's a duty. I don't really understand how we make love at what time (Laughed). That's what's nice.

Interviewer: [00:25:36] It develops at the moment.

Speaker: [00:25:37] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:25:42] (Unintelligible)

Speaker: [00:25:42] Because [partner] is a man

Interviewer: [00:25:44] Excuse me, please.

Speaker: [00:25:45] [Partner] is someone who is really very subtle about this subject and prepares you for that very much.

Interviewer: [00:26:00] How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker: [00:26:06] I swear I never thought about this question until now. I always thought that he loves me. I never thought the opposite. But if you ask me in my other relationships, it was always the thing that I lived with a big question mark in my mind. I wonder why it is like this. You know, I had relationships where I always asked the question of fifty percent or sometimes fifty-five percent. I mean, does he love me? But with [Partner], I never asked the question of do you love me. I never asked the question of how much he loves me. But I know he loves me, I feel it. I mean, knowing is not the right expression. I mean, I feel very deeply that he loves me. I feel it in his look, I feel it in his hug. However, we don't have such things like my love, my dear, my honey, which are constantly fictionalized. But when I'm sitting on the sofa, I don't know, he suddenly comes and kisses me, caresses my hair, holds my hand or suddenly holds my hand and kisses me like this while driving in the car, etc. These are things that I like and I feel that he loves me.

Interviewer: [00:27:20] If I understand correctly, it's not so much the symptoms that you see or (unintelligible), but rather the feelings that you realize that his feelings are passing on to you, the feelings that arise within you.

Speaker: [00:27:35] Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, I mean, if you don't have words like that, sometimes it's like, when I'm leaving the house, I say, "Ay lav yuuu" or something like that, and she says, "Me too, me too." (Laughs)

Interviewer: [00:27:56] So how do you think people know when their partner loves them?

Speaker: [00:28:04] The answer to this will be based on the people around me. I look at my brother and sister or I look at my other girlfriends. They evaluate them with the gifts they get. They say "he never said I love you, he never texted me". You know, they still have such very adolescent expectations. To me, love is not that. Love is something else. I mean, a diamond that he buys me every birthday or every special day does not express love for me. A handful of colorful beads also expresses love, which is much more meaningful and much more special for me. [Partner] even says to me, "It's the easiest thing in the world to make you happy. If I buy you a handful of colorful beads, it's really so." I mean, if he bought me a diamond, I would never be so happy.

Interviewer: [00:29:07] What would you say are the challenges in the relationship?

Speaker: [00:29:12] Oovv challenges in our relationship. I've been noticing them recently by comparing the relationship we had when we were lovers for [6-10] years with the relationship we had after we got married for [1-5] years. You know what Ilber [Partner] says: "In [Country A], the whole family is like a [folk dance], but abroad, it's like a tango with 2 people." But we experience this from time to time. My husband's mother is [81-85] years old, [Redacted]. Unfortunately, these are the most difficult things in my relationship lately, you know, not being able to manage that process.

Interviewer: [00:30:44] In what ways do you resolve your conflicts?

Speaker: [00:30:48] Sir?

Interviewer: [00:30:49] In what ways do you resolve your conflicts?

Speaker: [00:30:52] Well, sometimes I'm very quiet. A long silence. Sometimes I stand in front of him. I mean, I ask him. I say I'm at a dead end. Because she's a little bit older than me. And she's a person who has a different outlook on life. She has a different stance. I say, look, I'm at a dead end. Why is it like this? You know, help me. I mean. I'm walking this path with you. The obstacle in front of me is about you. We solve it by talking. But it's not like the first day it's not all beer and skittles, come on. It's a lot of cracking. After such mutual tension and so on, I say to myself, wait a minute, look, you're not going to solve it like this. Sit down and how? For them, it's very important. Your language of expression is so important. It's not what you are doing. It's not what he's doing. I mean, really. Or I don't want this. I mean, I have to find what I can tell him why it's happening. Mmm, the way of expression. And so far, I've found it ninety percent. (Laughs) Let's make it eighty-five percent. Ninety percent is a bit too much. Sometimes I can't find it.

Interviewer: [00:32:16] How often would you say you argue, you fight?

Speaker: [00:32:20] Fighting and arguing are two very different things for me. We had two very big arguments until today. Very, very big. In one of them I left home. Of course, if we ask [Partner]. That's a very unnecessary thing and actually there was no such big incident. But it was a very big incident inside me. Maybe I don't know. As he said, it was my ego battle. Maybe I felt

it really deeply. I was getting support from a psychologist at that time. Because as I said, I lived alone for [16-20] years. It was not easy for me to live with someone for a very long time. In my previous relationships, they could always be in my life when I wanted to be and I said stop when I didn't want to be. But it wasn't like that in this one. I mean, I live in the same house. And I live in a great responsibility. When I left, I didn't come back for a long time, 12-13 days. He never called and didn't do anything. But I wrote a letter to him, explaining why I left, what my feelings were. And when he replied to that letter, I was like, "Oh, I looked at it differently. Yes, I could look at it like that." The subject of discussion was our dog, a very big dog, and I was very uncomfortable with the dog's hair. Because I have an allergenic nature and [Partner] said that it was because I didn't want the dog, that it was my own obsession and my own invention. And I couldn't explain it to him. And he stubbornly kept taking the dog to the entrance of the house. And one day I said, what if I'm so ignored. And he said, you know, this dog will be here, you can go. He said something like, "Whoever doesn't want to accept it is welcome." He said, "You can go. This dog will stay here." in short. "Is that so?" I said, "I packed my things for 3-5 days." And I left. That day he realized that, "I'm really leaving." (she laughed) Even though I love him very much, I'm crazy enough to cut off nose to spite face. But of course, I'm not the kind of person who would leave [Partner] easily. But I was very scared of myself that day. We never had such an argument again. I never left the house, even if we did. Because we agreed on that. We said that it was a very wearing thing. It was very wearing on him and me. I didn't leave. We never had such a big fight. It wasn't a fight, actually. What I'm talking about is that the voices rose a little bit. Other than that, I mean, we agree. There are times when we disagree on some issues and give each other the wrong answers, but then we can forget it immediately and continue normally as if nothing had happened.

Interviewer: [00:35:24] If we define an argument as a raising of voices, taking a counter position and a conflict.

Speaker: [00:35:39] I don't know but I mean...

Interviewer: [00:35:42] If you were to throw a number, if you were to say one thing a week.

Speaker: [00:35:47] I don't know? I mean, we might have an argument once or twice a month. For example, [1-5] days ago I said something about his mother. He said ooooo, but it lasted three minutes, five minutes. Then, he said what will we eat this evening like nothing happened.

Interviewer: [00:36:11] What are the ways of maintaining the relationship, maintaining your relationship, other than just sitting and talking? In your relationship?

Speaker: [00:36:19] I mean, there's no other way to maintain our relationship than to sit and talk.

Interviewer: [00:36:25] So ways to ensure the continuity of the relationship?

Speaker: [00:36:30] The continuity of our relationship, as I said, we... I mean, I try to empathize with him, I try to understand him, I think he is the same way. Uh, I mean, the love (sevgi) we have for each other and most importantly, we are a couple who respect each other, and these are important reasons for the continuity of our relationship according to me.

Interviewer: [00:37:00] Trying to understand and empathize, respecting justified choices.

Speaker: [00:37:06] So I think so.

Interviewer: [00:37:09] Would you say that this relationship is good for you? Would you say that?

Speaker: [00:37:14] Yes, yes, I can say it very clearly. If it wasn't good, I would have ended this relationship already.

Interviewer: [00:37:22] How is it good?

Speaker: [00:37:24] Sir?

Interviewer: [00:37:25] How is it good?

Speaker: [00:37:28] I feel quite good with him. I don't feel suffocated at all. I used to feel very suffocated in my old relationships. I used to think that he should leave as soon as possible so that I could take a deep breath and stay alone in this house. If you say I've never experienced it, it wouldn't be a true statement, but maybe once or twice. But when I evaluate my other relationships, I know and feel that I live with [Partner] very joyfully.

Interviewer: [00:38:15] Can you give an example of something that was good for you?

Speaker: [00:38:20] For example, I come from work very tense, my mood is very bad. I'm like gunpowder, if you touch me, I'm like this, because I'm a very emotional person. We immediately have a glass of wine, he hugs me, kisses me. Even when I'm nervous, he says, "Oh, my rose is so sweet, my rose is so sweet, I don't know, I don't know." It's like that, and I can't get angry at that time, I can't get angry at anything, I forget what I'm going to get angry about, and then I say, "Wait a minute, I was going to say something, I was going to tell you." He says, "OK, you can tell me again," but I forget (Laughs).

Interviewer: [00:39:12] Well, it supports you in balancing your emotions. Sometimes.

Speaker: [00:39:17] Yes, he's a very good mentor for me. When I tell him things that I can't figure out, he doesn't say, oh, don't be silly, why are you stuck on this? Because there are [11-15] years between us, [11-15] years. I'm [46-50] and he's [56-60]. I mean, he's also very smart and he's someone who looks at relationships very differently and he comforts me a lot.

Interviewer: [00:39:57] Has this relationship changed you?

Speaker: [00:40:00] It changed me a lot. The people around me also expressed it. If you ask whether it was good or bad, it changed me very well and of course it had negative things as well. I was living a very frivolous life. He says, "I saved your life" or something like that as a joke, but actually it's not just a joke. I was someone who ate very unhealthy, drank alcohol, drank well, you know, I was someone who lived like that. Even when [Partner] first started to be with me, he said, "What am I going to do with this girl?" (Laughed). I mean, I didn't cook. I had no sense of family, to be honest. So getting married, having children, that was never on my mind. And when I got married, everyone was very surprised and the question they asked was: When are you going to get divorced? (Laughed). It changed me a lot. I adapted to live healthier. I realized myself. I realized that I didn't actually like going out so much, I was more of a homebody, I liked cooking, I was more of a meticulous person. Because I used to live at home with shoes on, I didn't care if the house was dirty or something like that. Now I've become the opposite, I've become more of a homebody, I mean, I'm happy to cook for him. By the way, of course, my old emotions are resurgent. No, I won't. I'm bored and I don't do it, of course. Nowadays he usually does it. That's how it is. It has changed me a lot. It has added a lot to my

life artistically. I used to always paint because I had to paint. Now I don't do it if I don't feel like it. I mean, I do it when I feel like it. I mean, it's not my duty. It's something I do with my feelings. But before, before I lived with [Partner], I had to draw something for an hour every day. I mustn't stop, I mustn't forget. But this is something I do with my feelings now. So it has added a lot of positive things to my life.

Interviewer: [00:42:37] You seem to be saying that you are liberated.

Speaker: [00:42:41] Actually it's like this. I used to think that I was very free. I used to live alone. I could do what I wanted when I wanted. But I was always running for someone. I had a lot of friends. I had so many. After I was with [Partner], when I entered another life, I realized that those friends of mine never called me. He just made me feel that they were using my environment and my opportunities. He didn't do it. I mean, living with him made me do it. I mean, he made me realize that. I mean, I realized that. I realized that there was nobody. And my life became simpler. It really became simpler.

Interviewer: [00:43:28] So has he changed?

Speaker: [00:43:32] I don't know. But his daughter said one day, "Dad, is this you, you are very different" (Laughs). For example, I think he is more patient with me than others around him. I look at him in his relationship with his mother. I observe him from the outside. He loves his mother very much, he values her very much. But I think he is more patient, more sensitive to me. That's what I feel. Women would not usually say that. They might say that he is more like this to his mother or more like that to others, more secretive, more cruel to me. But of course there are times when he is cruel to me. But in general, I think he is more sensitive to me.

Interviewer: [00:44:31] Do you think this started to happen during the relationship? Was it like this at the beginning?

Speaker: [00:44:37] No, at the beginning, he was good to me, he was super. I mean, in marriage, some things shifted a little bit in the union, but they are not such big changes. In fact, the spouse of a very close childhood friend of his made the following statement: "We have never seen him so peaceful and serene in his other relationship." Because you know, the way he expressed it, the way that friend expressed he is very serene and very peaceful with me.

Interviewer: [00:45:30] Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker: [00:45:35] There are times when I don't feel it, but in general I feel it. Here's what I don't feel. I mean, if something happens to him, when I am left alone, the feeling makes me do something like that. It scares me (laughed).

Interviewer: [00:46:06] So, do I understand correctly? You feel secure in the relationship. The times when you feel insecure, when you feel insecure, are related to the times when you imagine that you have lost Mr. [Partner].

Speaker: [00:46:20] I mean, when something like this happens about health or something like that, I feel uneasy, and then I say, don't be silly, you know, why are you thinking bad things?

Interviewer: [00:46:32] Can you explain in a sentence or two how you feel safe?

Interviewer: [00:46:38] On what basis did you say yes, for example? What kind of thing?

Speaker: [00:46:42] I mean, feeling safe is something like this for me. I know that [Partner] will be with me in case of a negative situation. For example, when I go to the hospital, if he has a job, he will leave and come with me. You know the feeling you have with your father. I mean, for example, I had that feeling with my father. Yes, if something happens to me, he is with me and he is my savior hero. You know, this may be perceived as insecurity, but that's not what I'm talking about. There, yes, he knows that I can find a solution. But when something big happens to me, I have no doubt that he will be there for me. For simple things, it's not like that, okay, I'm on your side, relax, but I'm sure that he is with me in serious matters.

Interviewer: [00:48:00] Is it possible to give an example?

Speaker: [00:48:03] Sir?

Interviewer: [00:48:04] Give an example.

Speaker: [00:48:07] I'll give you an example. Recently, I had a problem with my car, I called him and he said "I'm in a meeting, call the service". For example, I called the person who works at his workplace, and I asked for help. You know, he knows that I can solve it, or when I have a problem with my computer, he says "I'll tell you and you do it". But when I'm having a serious problem related to health, he can leave everything and be with me instantly and take me and solve it. Or when something happens with my family, he is someone who supports me immediately. Or when I open an exhibition, he experiences that emotion and excitement with me and helps me, brings me together. A supportive person.

Interviewer: [00:49:01] He also shares positive events with you.

Speaker: [00:49:04] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:49:10] We've come to the end of our open-ended questions. I have a few more questions for you, but I'm going to open them by showing you something. I'm going to ask you for a second. I'll hold it. I'll share a screen. Can you see it?

Speaker: [00:49:50] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:49:53] My partner usually really listens to me. If I ask you, one is not true at all, nine is completely true. How many would you say?

Speaker: [00:50:05] Uh, say seven. Seven between six and seven. Seven. Listens.

Interviewer: [00:50:10] I'm not saying it in the sense of listening advice, I'm not asking. Since there is a confusion in Turkish, these are translations from English, so I'm asking in the sense of listening.

Speaker: [00:50:25] So I already understood that he listens to me when I speak.

Interviewer: [00:50:28] Yes.

Speaker: [00:50:28] Do I understand correctly?

Interviewer: [00:50:29] You got that right.

Speaker: [00:50:32] Seven seven, listen, I mean, I would say seven.

Interviewer: [00:50:37] Why not six?

Speaker: [00:50:38] But if you ask him maybe.(Laughs). Uh, because I usually talk a lot, he says slowly (laughs). But when it's a serious subject, if I'm talking about a serious subject, he listens. I mean, eight, nine. It made me think a bit, but he listens. I mean, seven, eight and nine, but not six.

Interviewer: [00:51:08] Well, seven eight nine is also related to the seriousness of the subject you are talking about, its importance to you in a sense.

Speaker: [00:51:17] Yes, exactly, it's exactly like that. For example, if I'm talking about a silly subject at school, he'll listen and respond, but you know, he wants me to finish as soon as possible (Laughs).But I'm the kind of person who can't relax until I tell him about it. I tell him that you don't have to give an explanation, I feel relieved when I tell him.

Interviewer: [00:51:49] Well, if I ask you, is my partner usually sensitive to my needs?

Speaker: [00:51:54] Eight.

Interviewer: [00:51:55] Nine... okay.

Speaker: [00:51:56] Eight.

Interviewer: [00:51:58] Why not seven?

Speaker: [00:52:02] Generally, he's always been responsive so far. I would say it's completely correct, but there might be some small things that I missed. Eight is more realistic (Laughs).

Interviewer: [00:52:16] You seem to be saying that nothing is perfect, nine would be perfect.

Speaker: [00:52:21] Exactly. I mean, I always say that our relationship is not such an extraordinary dream, but it's not right to compare it with many relationships anyway. It's a good relationship in its own balance. I mean, it's a livable relationship. We don't make life miserable for each other. And we don't have obligations. I mean, many couples live for children.I don't know, they stay together for financial opportunities, they stay together for family, etc. We don't have any of that. We just, I'm telling you from my point of view, I'm in this relationship because I love him and I enjoy him. Marriage is not important to me either. I lived with this person for [6-10] years. I mean, if it was really difficult and something made me unhappy, if I wasn't satisfied, I could end it very easily.

Interviewer: [00:53:20] If I ask you how satisfied you are with your relationship in general.

Speaker: [00:53:24] I'm very pleased. I'm very pleased.

Interviewer: [00:53:30] Just a second then, since you said I'm very satisfied, how many would you give so that zero means I'm not satisfied at all and ten means I'm completely satisfied?

Speaker: [00:53:48] Well, I am very pleased, eight or nine would be very appropriate.

Interviewer: [00:53:57] Why not ten?

Speaker: [00:54:00] As I just said, I mean, relationships have their ups and downs, I'm totally satisfied. I mean, we're two different people and we can have ups and downs, as I just said.

Interviewer: [00:54:40] Can you give me one example of your partner's sensitivity towards your needs?

Speaker: [00:54:46] For example, I'm going to go to [Country B] for an exhibition meeting. He can look at the weather, he says "take your raincoat or it will be very cold, do this". Maybe this may not be exactly the equivalent of it, it may seem simple, but it is an important thing for me, or if I'm depressed and unhappy when I come home, I can say okay, let's do something today and manage my situation positively at that moment. Or if I'm painting, if there's an exhibition, what I need at that moment is a coffee, a tea, something hot. Or someone who is very comfortable with things like a positive aa very nice or why is this like that.

Interviewer: [00:55:53] You seem to feel that there is support.

Speaker: [00:55:56] Yeah. You know, let's not say that I can't solve, but when I'm in trouble, you know, at the points where I want to breathe, yes, he helps me breathe.

Interviewer: [00:56:18] We have come to the end of our interview and I have no more questions. We have a procedural issue, you know, about how we can use the data we have collected, but before we get to that, I would like to give a small summary of what we talked about, if that's okay with you.

Speaker: [00:56:39] I'm listening, I'm listening.

Interviewer: [00:56:41] If there is anything missing anywhere, if there is anything you want to add, if there is anything I misunderstood, please correct me, so I want to go over it again. You are [46-50] years old, you have been together for [11-15] years, you have been married for [1-5] years, you have been lovers for [6-10] years, your husband has [1-5] daughters, you have no children, you live at home with your husband and two pets. You are an [Job Title].

Speaker: [00:57:09] Our dog, our dog is outside the house but we're together. Our cat is inside the house.

Interviewer: [00:57:16] You are an [Job Title] and you also do

Speaker: [00:57:19] [Job B].

Interviewer: [00:57:21] Exactly. When I asked how we met, I said that a friend of yours recommended you for her daughter while she was giving private lessons and that your relationship started from there. His daughter and his eldest daughter felt close to you and you were enjoying spending time together, you were going to the movies together, you were going to theaters, you were spending time together. That you found yourself in a relationship of lovers, not that you became lovers on an agreement, but that it developed naturally.

Speaker: [00:57:57] Exactly.

Interviewer: [00:57:58] You almost told me. Uh-huh.

Speaker: [00:58:01] You express it very, very well (Laughs)

Interviewer: [00:58:06] I'm glad (laughing). When he asked if you can compare your relationship with other relationships, you said that your relationship is different, that you have not lost respect for each other despite the time that has passed, that you call each other [Nickname] and rose. You mentioned that you are not like lovers, that he is not a lover, nor is he married, married, that there are distances in the marriages you see outside, that you enjoy each other, that you give each other space, that you respect each other's boundaries, that you are

respectful of each other's boundaries, that when we put pressure to compare, I think we are good. I think we are better than our surroundings. In a sense. Uh, because I forced it. When I asked about your past relationships, you mentioned that you had a lot of relationships, but you had 2-3 relationships that you could call serious.

Speaker: [00:59:06] I mean very much more than the relationship of women in [Country A]. You know, we have

Interviewer: [00:59:14] According to norms

Speaker: [00:59:14] Either you marry your lover or you marry the third one, you know. So of course, when I got married at the age of [36-40] (Laughs).

Interviewer: [00:59:23] Then we can say that there is a standard of III according to European norms, not according to [Country A] norms.

Speaker: [00:59:31] Yeah yeah that's more yeah right. Speaker.

Interviewer: [00:59:35] Uh, you said that it's much better than your past relationships, that it's sincere, that it's not showy, that it's sincere, that even though it's less of a showy, ego-gratifying behavior like it used to be, the fact that it's sincere is very valuable to you.

Speaker: [01:00:03] Yes.

Interviewer: [01:00:05] I have to go back in the questions, sorry.

Speaker: [01:00:09] So yes it was just a relationship.

Interviewer: [01:00:18] When I asked what makes a relationship high quality, you mentioned that it is important to have respect, to know the boundaries, to know the clear points, to have common actions and sharing, that it is important not to control each other, not to involve families too much, not to interfere in each other's lives, you mentioned that language is important, what is said and how it is expressed during interaction. When I asked what makes relationships of low quality, you said that relationships in which there is no listening, no empathy, no empathy, no ignoring are low quality relationships. When I asked what love is, you said that love is labor, love and respect. You said that in your previous relationships you had a more movie-like definition of love, that excitement, heart palpitations, longing, big shows of affection were important, but now small things, gestures, looks, contacts are important. You said that the most important things in the relationship are to act according to the needs of the other person, that sometimes your own needs and priorities are put aside, to be able to give importance to the other person, to be able to listen, to be able to ask. You said that a sharp mind is important. You said that it is important to be at a level of maturity to be able to think about the other person in order to get out of conflicts. And I took note that you learned these things by distilling them from your negative relationships. But because you learned by distilling

Speaker: [01:02:21] That's right, actually, yes, by living. And of course, it's also very much related to how the other person makes you feel.

Interviewer: [01:02:43] After that we talked a little bit about your sexual life, you mentioned that you are quite satisfied, that you enjoy your sexuality very much, that your partner is very respectful, liberating, that there are no taboos in your relationship sexuality, that you are attentive to each other's needs.

Speaker: [01:03:06] Yes

Interviewer: [01:02:43] You mentioned that you are satisfied. You said that we make love two or three times a week.

Speaker: [01:03:12] Yes

Interviewer: [01:03:13] You also mentioned that there were times when he wasn't there, and when I asked you how do you know if the other person loves you, you said you never doubted it, you said you knew compared to your previous relationships, although maybe the word know is not the right word.

Speaker: [01:03:34] Well, your voice started to echo in between.

Interviewer: [01:03:40] How are we doing right now? Maybe it's the position of where I put the paper, I'm talking, is there an echo?

Speaker: [01:03:48] Uh, can you make a sentence?

Interviewer: [01:03:51] I'm talking, I'm talking, I'm making sentences.

Speaker: [01:03:53] Okay, okay, okay. (Laughs). Because sometimes there is an echo in the sound and it dissipates and I can't understand it.

Interviewer: [01:04:00] Okay, is there anything you don't understand, you can't hear? Should I take it back?

Speaker: [01:04:06] I couldn't hear the part after the...I couldn't hear the part after the...most of the sentences in this relationship...in this sexuality, most of the sentences echoed and I can't remember them at all.

Interviewer: [01:04:26] Okay, we've talked about the following. You answered the question of how do you know if someone likes you by saying that you know, uh, do I try changing the microphone again?

Speaker: [01:04:42] I'm pretty much trying to focus right now. I was doing very well, but all of a sudden there was an echo and a breakup in the sound, I don't understand.

Interviewer: [01:04:50] How is it now?

Speaker: [01:04:50] I maybe have a charge...Okay, cool.

Interviewer: [01:04:54] Are we better?

Speaker: [01:04:54] Mm-hmm, very good.

Interviewer: [01:04:55] Okay. When I asked you how do you know that the other person loves you, you said that you never think about the answer to this question, but if you do, you feel it deeply, you understand it from the look, from the hug, from the contact, from the words, it's inside you. You mentioned that people often have adolescent expectations, they look for love in more concrete things, but that's not love. When we talked about the difficulties, the challenges of your relationship, you mentioned that the challenges of the period when you were lovers and the challenges of the period when you were married were different. You mentioned that your current difficulties are related to family matters, that your husband's mother spends more time

with you out of obligation in a sense, and that you don't like her interfering with your time space, and you talked about the importance of finding the right words to be understood, even if you are strained and fractured by talking about these things. At the end of the silences, you talked about the importance of communication in order to always get along. You mentioned that you had two big arguments, I won't go into the details of your argument, but you also mentioned that you had difficulties living together, while talking about the difficulties, you mentioned that after living alone for [16-20] years, there was a big change and you had to adapt. You talked about the need for understanding, understanding, empathy and respect to build continuity.

Speaker: [01:06:44] Yes.

Interviewer: [01:06:45] You talked about your relationship as being good for you, that you don't feel suffocated, that you feel good, that you live with joy, that even when you come home from work like a gunpowder, for example, he comforts you with his love, his words, his behavior, he takes away your gunpowder.

Speaker: [01:07:06] Yes, very much.

Interviewer: [01:07:07] You mentioned that you changed a lot during your relationship, that you lived a very frivolous, very unhealthy, unhealthier life before, that you had no sense of family, but that you became healthier in this relationship, that you got to know yourself more, that you realized your homeliness, that you realized your meticulousness, that you became free in your art, that you made art according to your whims.

Speaker: [01:07:38] The voice is gone. Oh, no.

Interviewer: [01:07:40] I'm talking, I'm talking.

Speaker: [01:07:43] Uh, the sound is gone. Can you hear it?

Interviewer: [01:07:46] I can hear you. Can you hear me?

Speaker: [01:07:48] Okay, okay. Because the moment the call went in, it's gone. Now it's super. Okay.

Interviewer: [01:07:53] Uh, you mentioned that you are healthier now, that you know yourself better, that you are more domesticated, that you are more meticulous, that you have found the space to live these things, that you have begun to give more importance to your enjoyment in your art, that you have become more patient, more sensitive, more peaceful and serene. You talked about being secure in this relationship (unintelligible), you talked about having your needs met, you talked about the kind of security that people have with their fathers, you talked about knowing that he is there for you when you are struggling, when you are in trouble. That's more or less what we talked about.

Speaker: [01:08:39] Yeah, okay, well, it's a nuisance. Yeah.

Interviewer: [01:08:46] So we are right.

Speaker: [01:08:48] Yes.

Interviewer: [01:08:50] This summary, how did it feel to hear the summary?

Speaker: [01:08:55] I mean, I wondered if I had said something exaggerated or if there was something missing. You know, every time you repeated the sentence, I internally confirmed that I had said something that I believed to be true. I said it very thoughtfully. I didn't want to use biblical terms. I tried to express whatever emotional and living things were.

Interviewer: [01:08:24] Sincerely

Speaker: [01:09:25] So (Laughs). I hope it was very enjoyable for you as well. Thank you.

Interviewer: [01:09:31] Thank you very much for sharing, for your efforts, for your hard work.

Speaker: [01:09:38] (Laughs). Speaker.

Interviewer: [01:09:42] I have one question left. Now you have three options on what to do with the data that we collect from you, one is to say don't use it, I withdraw this consent, you can always do that. I want to underline that, even after [1-5] months.

Speaker: [01:10:00] Do you use my name?

Interviewer: [01:10:03] It will be anonymized. That is, where you live, your spouse's name and your name will be removed from the public information that can identify you.

Speaker: [01:10:16] I got it.

Interviewer: [01:10:16] Information to keep. There are two options. One is to say that you can use the whole transcript. The anonymized version of course. So we won't use your audio and video anywhere. They're for transcription that I know of.

Speaker: [01:10:31] Got it.

Interviewer: [01:10:32] Things we understand.

Speaker: [01:10:33] Got it.

Interviewer: [01:10:34] Or you can use the uh, parts of uh.

Speaker: [01:10:38] Nah, you can use mine. I mean, because of the things that I've been through, you know, I don't feel bad about it, like I said.

Interviewer: [01:10:51] It will be anonymized.

Speaker: [01:10:54] Uh, yeah.

Interviewer: [01:10:56] Then that's it.

Speaker: [01:10:57] Okay. Thank you very much. Nice to meet you. Bye.

Interviewer: [01:10:58] Thank you very much, it's a pleasure. I couldn't reach your husband. Can you let me know when he gets back?

Speaker: [01:11:05] Now he has gone inside. He went to the market again because I was busy. See, you know, another example. If it was another partner, you know, it's quarter to five o'clock, and I'm sitting here very relaxed. So it's good not to have that tension. Oh, he's here. What am I going to do? I don't have that panic. But in other relationships it's too much. I don't go into the mode of having to close immediately. I have to make dinner.

Interviewer: [01:11:32] Yes you didn't.

Speaker: [01:11:33] (Laughs). See you. Bye. I'll say it. Bye. Bye. Bye.

Interviewer: [01:11:38] Thank you very much. Good day.

Speaker: [01:11:42] bye